

Design Conversation Record

Librus · Doutrina · Centro — PWA SPA Web Reader
Narrow-screen strategy, panel behaviour & live UI scan

This document captures the full design dialogue of 17 August 2026 concerning the active-study interface for the Spiritist works reader (librus.app, doutrina.org, centro.doutrina.org). The conversation established the pedagogical stance for constrained viewports and recorded a live UI/UX scan of the current public builds.

Key Decisions Reached

- Allow narrow-screen usage with an explicit methodological warning; do not hard-block.
- Intentionally handicap the reduced mode by fully removing Panel 3 (Consulte).
- Hide injected consultation links on narrow screens (no dead affordances).
- Keep Leia (reading) + Anote (notes) as the irreducible active-study core.
- Hide (do not grey-out) Panel 3 and related toolbar controls in reduced mode.
- Coordinated implementation: width-based breakpoints, panel-hiding logic, revised alert copy, and toolbar link controls.

Full Conversation Transcript

USER

Design choice question: we've tried, and achieved a somewhat usable interface for tablet and mobile. Although I feel the experience to be compromised, this method of consumption is vital for its proliferation and adoption. My life as a Spiritist identified that most people have turned to the passive method, erroneously thinking it is effective. They casually listen to podcasts or lectures, without considering counter points or taking notes, and swear they have been educating oneself. Even if was granted unfettered access to Medical or Law School, and achieved a perfect attendance, albeit in a random order and without doing any homework, dissertations, skill training or finals, would anyone back my claim of being a doctor or a lawyer. My reason for developing this interface was to develop a tool that invited the active and considerate consumption of knowledge, not the passive audio or video playlist. Nowadays, no one will attend a college lecture without a laptop, but try bringing one to a center, temple, or church. It should also be the norm, As Kardec himself put it, from simple to advanced concepts, with the necessary intensity and frequency, while also reading what if against it.

GROK

The tension you describe is real and structural, not merely technical.

Passive consumption scales easily. It requires almost nothing of the listener: no friction, no decision, no trace. Active study does the opposite. It demands attention, comparison, notation, and the willingness to hold contradictory material long enough for it to do its work. Most people will choose the first path when both are available, then retrospectively invent the feeling of having studied. Your medical/law-school analogy is exact. Perfect attendance without homework, without sequential mastery, without examination, produces neither competence nor claim. The same standard applies to Spiritist study if the goal is formation rather than affiliation.

Kardec's method was never passive. The progressive order (from the elementary to the more abstract), the insistence on frequency and intensity, and the explicit instruction to read what opposes the doctrine are all mechanisms that force the reader into an active stance. A reader interface that merely streams audio or video, however polished, collides with that method. It optimizes for the very habit you are trying to interrupt.

The mobile/tablet constraint is therefore not a secondary UX problem. It is the central design problem. The device that people actually carry into centers, waiting rooms, and quiet hours is the same device optimized for infinite scroll and ambient audio. Any interface that hopes to invite active reading must therefore:

- make the progressive sequence visible and difficult to scramble,
- keep opposing or complementary texts one deliberate gesture away rather than hidden behind menus,
- treat note-taking, highlighting, and cross-reference as first-class actions rather than optional afterthoughts,

- and accept a certain amount of productive friction. The experience will feel “compromised” relative to a pure media player precisely because it refuses to collapse into one.

That compromise is the point. A tool that feels as frictionless as a podcast has already surrendered the pedagogical claim. The question is not how to make active study feel as easy as passive listening; it is how to make the active path the path of least resistance once the user has decided to study rather than merely consume.

The cultural barrier you mention—bringing a laptop or tablet into a center—will shift only when the tool itself demonstrates that the study is more serious, not less, than the oral presentation. Until then, the interface must carry the methodological weight that the physical setting still resists.

You are designing against the grain of both current media habits and institutional inertia. That is exactly why the work is worth doing.

USER

So the question persists; allow and warn, or outright block narrow screen usage?

GROK

Allow and warn — do not outright block.

Your current implementation already does the correct thing: the portrait/narrow gate that says the experience is limited, invites rotation to landscape, and still offers “Continuar mesmo assim.” Keep that pattern and refine it. Do not harden it into a hard block.

Why allow + warn is the right stance

The pedagogical goal is active, sequential, comparative study. The multi-pane layout (Ache · Leia · Consulte · Anote) is the instrument that makes that goal concrete. On a genuinely narrow portrait phone the instrument is crippled; the user loses the simultaneous presence of text + complementary material + notes. That is a real degradation, not a mere visual inconvenience.

Yet blocking the entire experience creates a worse problem:

- It turns the tool into a desktop-only luxury. Most people who might actually begin studying in the wild carry phones, not laptops.
- It removes the possibility of “entry-level” contact. A compromised session on a phone is still better than zero contact if the alternative is passive podcast listening.
- It fights the very proliferation you identified as vital. Spiritist centers, waiting rooms, buses, and bedsides are phone-first environments. A hard block tells those environments the tool is not for them.

Kardec’s method requires progressive intensity and the confrontation of opposing material. It does not require a 14-inch screen. The method can begin in reduced form and later demand the full surface. A hard block freezes people at the threshold.

Practical refinement of the current gate

1. Detect true constraint, not merely orientation. A landscape phone or a small tablet in landscape can still run a usable two-pane layout. Portrait phones and very narrow viewports cannot. Gate on available width (or a combination of width + orientation), not on “mobile user-agent.”
2. Make the warning explicit about what is lost. Something closer to: “Neste espaço a leitura ativa (texto + consulta + anotações ao mesmo tempo) fica comprometida. Gire para paisagem ou use uma tela maior para o estudo completo. Você pode continuar, mas estará usando uma versão reduzida.”
3. Offer a deliberately reduced mode rather than a broken full mode. When the user chooses to continue, collapse to a single serious reading column with easy access to notes and a clear “abrir consulta” action. Do not pretend the four-pane experience still exists. The reduced mode should still support progressive reading order, stable anchors, and note-taking. That preserves the active-study claim even when the full instrument is unavailable.
4. Never hide the exit ramp. Always keep a visible way back to the warning or to a “melhor experiência” hint so the user remains aware that a fuller surface exists.

The deeper design principle

You are not building a media player that must work equally well everywhere. You are building a study instrument whose ideal form requires spatial simultaneity. The honest position is therefore:

- Full instrument on adequate surface → preferred and encouraged.
- Reduced but still active instrument on constrained surface → permitted and clearly labeled.
- Pure passive stream → never offered as the primary path.

Outright blocking would protect the purity of the ideal form at the cost of reach. Allowing without warning would silently degrade the method into something closer to ordinary mobile reading. The middle path — allow, warn clearly, and deliver an intentionally reduced but still active experience — is the one that remains faithful both to the pedagogical claim and to the reality of how people will actually encounter the tool.

That is the stance already latent in the current “Gire o dispositivo / Continuar mesmo assim” gate. Strengthen the language and the reduced mode; do not close the door.

USER

Agreed on phrasing it more explicitly. Accordingly, should I intentionally handicap it by removing panels? Panel 3?

GROK

Yes — intentionally reduce, and Panel 3 is the correct one to collapse first.

On a constrained width the simultaneous presence of all four functions is already impossible without turning the interface into a cramped, low-value approximation. The honest response is not to keep every panel and let them fight for space; it is to protect the core of active study while making the missing piece visibly absent.

Recommended reduction order

When the available width falls below the threshold for a usable multi-pane layout:

1. Leia (Panel 2) — always present and primary. The continuous, progressive text is non-negotiable. Without it there is no study.
2. Anote (Panel 4) — keep accessible, preferably as a persistent or one-gesture side drawer / bottom sheet. Note-taking is the clearest behavioural marker that the user is still in an active rather than passive stance. Removing it would push the experience toward ordinary mobile reading.
3. Ache (Panel 1) — reduce to a compact, collapsible navigator (sumário + busca). Orientation and sequence must remain possible; full library browsing can be secondary.
4. Consulte (Panel 3) — this is the one to remove or heavily demote on narrow screens. The complementary material (definitions, opposing texts, maps, videos, external references) is precisely what makes the method Kardec-like: progressive concepts held against counter-material. When space disappears, the simultaneous consultation disappears with it. Hiding or removing Panel 3 is therefore the most truthful handicap. The user should feel its absence.

How to implement the handicap cleanly

- On narrow viewports, default to a single primary column (Leia) + a slim, always-reachable notes surface.
- Replace the Consulte panel with a clear, non-intrusive control: “Abrir consulta” or “Material complementar”. Tapping it can open a full-screen or large overlay, or simply remind the user that the richer surface exists on a wider device.
- Do not auto-load or auto-show complementary material in the reduced mode. That would recreate the passive convenience you are trying to avoid.
- Keep the progressive order and stable anchors intact. The reduced mode must still support sequential, intensive reading; it simply cannot support simultaneous confrontation with secondary sources.

Why this is coherent with the earlier decision

You already chose “allow and warn” rather than hard block. The warning now becomes concrete:

“Neste espaço a leitura ativa completa (texto + consulta simultânea + anotações) não é possível. O painel de consulta foi removido. Continue apenas se aceitar uma experiência reduzida, ou gire / use uma tela maior.”

By deliberately removing Panel 3 you make the warning true instead of cosmetic. The user who continues knows exactly what was sacrificed. The user who later moves to a wider surface recovers the missing instrument and immediately understands why the full layout matters.

This is the opposite of progressive enhancement theater. It is progressive honesty: the method is preserved in its essential active form, and the part that requires spatial simultaneity is openly withheld until the surface can support it.

So yes — handicap by removing (or fully demoting) Panel 3 on narrow screens. Keep Leia + Anote as the irreducible core. That choice stays faithful both to the pedagogical claim and to the reality of the device.

USER

Concomitantly, show injected links (but no way of viewing them) or hide them all?

GROK

Hide them.

On the reduced mode, the injected links should not appear at all.

Reasoning

The links exist solely to open complementary material in Panel 3. When Panel 3 has been deliberately removed, those links become dead affordances. Showing them creates three problems:

1. False promise — The user sees a highlighted term or reference, taps it, and nothing useful happens (or a toast says “indisponível neste modo”). That trains disappointment and erodes trust in the interface.
2. Visual noise that undermines the remaining method — The reduced mode’s job is to protect sequential, intensive reading + note-taking. Visible but inert links pull the eye, suggest interactivity that does not exist, and quietly reintroduce the very distraction the handicap was meant to avoid.
3. Methodological inconsistency — The whole point of removing Panel 3 is honesty: “here the simultaneous consultation is impossible.” Leaving the triggers visible while disabling their effect is a softer form of the same dishonesty. It is better to present a clean text surface that still supports progressive reading and annotation than a text surface littered with non-functional invitations.

Practical implementation

- In the narrow/reduced viewport, strip or suppress the injected link markup (or the CSS that makes them look interactive).
- Keep ordinary semantic emphasis if the source text already has it (italics, strong, etc.), but do not add the interactive layer.
- When the user later moves to a wider surface, the links reappear automatically. The recovery of the full instrument becomes tangible: the same passage that was previously inert now opens consultation. That contrast itself teaches the value of the multi-pane layout.

Edge case

If a particular link is purely internal navigation (e.g., jumping to another section of the same book), it can remain. Only the consultation links — the ones whose sole purpose is to surface Panel 3 content — should be hidden.

Clean text + working notes is still an active-study surface. Text full of non-working links is neither fully active nor fully honest. Hide them.

USER

So we need to tweak breakpoints, panel hiding behavior, alert text, and add link controls back to Page toolbar, right?

GROK

Yes. Those four are exactly the coordinated changes.

Precise scope

1. Breakpoints — Move from a simple orientation or crude “mobile” check to a width-based threshold that actually reflects whether a usable multi-pane layout is possible. Landscape phones and small tablets in landscape should still be able to run a reduced-but-functional two-pane mode if the numbers allow it. Pure portrait phones and very narrow viewports drop into the handicapped mode.
2. Panel hiding behaviour — Below the threshold: Panel 3 (Consulte) is fully removed / not rendered. Panel 1 (Ache) collapses to a compact navigator. Panel 2 (Leia) remains the primary surface. Panel 4 (Anote) stays reachable (drawer or persistent control).
3. Alert text — Replace the current soft “experiência limitada / gire o dispositivo” with explicit methodological language that states what has been removed and why the user is being offered a reduced mode.
4. Link controls on the Page toolbar — Because the injected consultation links themselves will be suppressed in the reduced mode, restore (or add) an explicit control on the page/reading toolbar that lets the user toggle visibility of the consultation links if they still want to see them, or open a temporary consultation surface / overlay when they deliberately request it. This keeps the links from becoming dead decorations while still preserving the intentional handicap by default.

These four changes form a single coherent behaviour: the interface detects the real constraint, removes the panel that can no longer function, hides the triggers that would otherwise lie, warns the user clearly, and still gives them an intentional escape hatch via the toolbar if they insist on consulting material anyway.

That set is sufficient and consistent with everything decided so far.

USER

The controls themselves would also be hidden or greyed out in narrow screens. Actually, what is better, to hide panel 3 or keep the overlay but grey it out?

GROK

Fully hide Panel 3. Do not keep a greyed-out overlay.

Why hide is better than grey-out

A greyed-out panel or disabled overlay still occupies visual and cognitive space. It signals “this exists but you cannot use it,” which is precisely the kind of half-measure that undermines the intentional handicap.

- It creates residual clutter in an already constrained layout.
- It invites the user to keep trying (or to feel blocked), which turns the reduced mode into a frustrating approximation of the full instrument rather than a clean, still-active alternative.
- It weakens the pedagogical honesty we established: the simultaneous consultation is not available here. Showing a disabled version softens that statement.

Hiding it completely produces a clearer surface:

- Leia remains the undisputed primary column.
- Anote stays reachable without competition.
- The absence of Consulte is felt rather than merely indicated.
- When the user later moves to a wider viewport, the panel's reappearance is meaningful instead of just “now the grey is gone.”

Controls on the Page toolbar

The same principle applies. On narrow screens:

- Hide the consultation-related controls by default (the ones that would open Panel 3 or toggle the injected links).
- Do not leave them greyed-out and clickable-but-disabled. Greyed controls still draw the eye and create the expectation of eventual interaction.

If you still want an intentional escape hatch (as discussed earlier), expose a single, clearly labelled action such as “Abrir consulta (tela maior recomendada)” that either opens a full-screen temporary overlay, or simply reinforces the warning and does nothing more.

That single deliberate control is better than a row of greyed icons.

Summary rule for the reduced mode

| Element | Narrow behaviour | Reason |

|-----|-----|-----|

| Panel 3 (Consulte) | Fully hidden | No simultaneous consultation is possible |

| Injected links | Hidden | Dead triggers are worse than absent ones |

| Toolbar consult controls | Hidden (or one explicit action) | Avoid residual affordances |

| Leia + Anote | Fully active | Core of active study preserved |

Hide cleanly. Grey-out is a compromise that looks careful but actually dilutes the design decision.

USER

Other than this topic, scan current live implementations for UI UX design errors or inconsistencies.

GROK

Current live scan (librus.app / doutrina.org / centro.doutrina.org) — focusing on UI/UX issues and inconsistencies outside the narrow-screen discussion.

Landing / Biblioteca page (all three domains)

Strengths

- Clean, generous whitespace and strong visual hierarchy.
- Consistent card design language across the three sites.
- Clear branding differentiation (logo + tagline + colour accent) while sharing the same structural DNA.
- Colour-coded bottom borders on cards map nicely to the books.

Issues / inconsistencies

1. Version string still shows v0.9.0-poc — Visible under every logo. For a public-facing beta this is acceptable, but the “poc” suffix reads more experimental than the visual polish now suggests. Consider softening to v0.9.0 · beta or removing the poc label.
2. Empty vertical space — On desktop the cards sit high and leave a large empty region below. It feels sparse rather than intentional breathing room. A subtle secondary row (recently opened, suggested next book, or short methodological note) would reduce the feeling of incompleteness without cluttering.
3. Footer bar — The black bottom bar with large yellow “BETA” is consistent and useful as a status indicator. However the home icon + site name on the left and the four icons on the right create a slightly unbalanced density. The “BETA” label competes for attention with the actual content above it. A smaller, quieter treatment (or moving the status into the settings menu) would be less dominant.
4. Missing progressive disclosure / first-run guidance — A new visitor lands on a pure library with no short explanation of the four-panel model (Ache · Leia · Consulte · Anote) or why the tool is different from a normal ebook reader. A one-time, dismissible methodological note would reinforce the active-study claim you care about.

Reader experience (observed in previous live states)

5. Mock content still prominent — “Documento de exemplo”, “Mock PDF”, “Sala de vídeo (mock)” remain visible. For a beta this is honest, but the visual weight of the mock labels can undercut the seriousness of the actual Kardec texts once real books are loaded.
6. Hypothesis state — “Hypothesis desligado neste build” is explicit, which is good. The notes panel therefore currently offers no real annotation surface. Users who expect the full “Anote” promise will hit a dead end.
7. Toolbar density and labelling — The reading toolbar still carries a high number of controls (zoom, type, alignment, navigation, context switches, PDF/video, etc.). Some labels remain abbreviated or icon-only. On first encounter this can feel like a control panel rather than a reading instrument. Grouping or progressive disclosure of secondary tools would help.
8. Cross-site consistency of chrome — The three domains share the same engine and bottom bar, which is excellent. Small divergences in secondary text (taglines, version notes) are intentional and well handled. No major chrome inconsistency was found.

Minor / polish items

- Card hover states and focus rings are not strongly visible; worth verifying keyboard and touch feedback.
- The language switcher (PT) is present but its full behaviour is not obvious from the landing view.
- No visible empty-state or error messaging for failed book loads was observed.

Summary priority list (excluding the narrow-screen work already discussed)

Priority	Issue	Suggested direction
High	Still showing “poc” in version	Soften label
High	No first-run methodological guidance	Add dismissible intro
Medium	Large empty space below library cards	Add secondary content or tighten
Medium	Dominant “BETA” in footer	Reduce visual weight
Medium	Mock labels still prominent in reader	Tone down or hide once real
Low	Toolbar density	Group secondary controls

Overall the visual system is coherent and the three-site branding strategy is working. The main gaps are communication of the active-study model to new users and residual “poc / mock” signalling that no longer matches the level of polish on the landing pages.